# WISE Chapter Resource Guide

Last updated: November 2026 (previous version: December 2025)

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## 1. Purpose

WISE Connections helps university supply chain students build meaningful relationships. Through campus programming, national events, industry engagement, mentorship, and a national network of peers and professionals, students involved with WISE gain experiences and connections that help them thrive in college and beyond.

## 2. About WISE

### 2.1 Mission and Story

**Mission:** WISE creates opportunities for students to build connections, develop professionally, strengthen leadership skills, and gain industry knowledge that prepares them for impactful careers in supply chain management.

WISE started as a student organization at the University of Arkansas. It has grown into a national network of campus chapters, a student advisory board, and the annual WISE Future Leaders Symposium. The first symposium brought together students and faculty from 12 universities; the 2026 symposium had more than 35 universities.

### 2.2 The Four WISE Pillars

- **Making Connections:** relationships with peers, alumni, faculty, and industry professionals.
- **Personal and Professional Development:** career skills, confidence, and personal growth.
- **Leadership Skills:** leading with confidence, integrity, and purpose.
- **Supply Chain Industry Knowledge:** understanding how supply chains work and the careers in them.

Plan each semester so that every pillar is covered at least once.

## 3. Shape

### 3.1 Universities with WISE Chapters

18 chapters as of June 2026:

| University | Social Media |
|---|---|
| Auburn University | @auburnwise |
| Colorado State University | @csuwise |
| Georgia Southern University | LinkedIn: wise-gsu |
| Indiana University Bloomington | @wise_iu |
| Iowa State University | @wiseiastate |
| Miami University | @miamiohwise |
| Michigan State University | @msuwise |
| Mississippi State University* | @msu_mwsc |
| North Carolina A&T State University | @ncatwise |
| Texas Tech University | @ttuwise |
| University of Arkansas | @uarkwise |
| University of Central Florida | @ucfwise |
| University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign | @wise.uiuc |
| University of Kansas | @ku.wise |
| University of Oklahoma | @ouwise |
| University of Texas at Dallas | @wise_utd |
| University of Wisconsin-Madison | @wiseatuw |
| Western Michigan University | @wmuwise |

*Mississippi State's WISE group is a committee inside the Maroon and White Supply Chain club, so it uses the club's Instagram account.

### 3.2 Interested in Starting a Chapter

Reach out to Dr. Stephanie Thomas, sthomas@walton.uark.edu, so they can help you out with starting one.

### 3.3 Chapter Structure

Chapters are set up either as a standalone WISE club or as a committee inside a Supply Chain organization. Examples:

#### 3.3.1 Integrated within a Supply Chain / Logistics Club

- Auburn
- Georgia Southern
- Michigan State
- Mississippi State*
- Western Michigan

#### 3.3.2 Standalone Registered WISE Organization

- Colorado State
- Iowa State
- University of Arkansas
- University of Kansas

*Mississippi State has about 10 highly engaged WISE members inside a supply chain club of about 100 students.

### 3.4 Few Examples for Meeting Frequency

| University | Typical Cadence | Duration |
|---|---|---|
| Auburn | 2-3 events per semester | About 1 hr |
| Colorado State | 2 full chapter programs per semester + socials | About 1 hr |
| Georgia Southern | 2 meetings per month + 1 large event per semester | About 1 hr |
| Iowa State | 4 meetings per semester + 1 flagship panel | About 1.5 hr |
| Kansas | 4 workshops per semester | About 1 hr |
| Michigan State | 1-2 meetings per month | About 1 hr |
| Mississippi State | Biweekly supply chain club meetings; 1 WISE event per semester | About 1 hr |
| University of Arkansas | Monthly | About 1.5 hr |
| Western Michigan | 2 meetings per semester + mixer | About 1 hr |

### 3.5 Chapter Size

**Small:** Auburn, Colorado State, Iowa State, Western Michigan

**Medium:** Michigan State, University of Kansas

**Large:** Georgia Southern, University of Arkansas

## 4. Advice for Planning Impactful Meetings

Use the four WISE pillars to plan a balanced semester.

### 4.1 Making Connections

**Programming ideas:**

- Alumni and employer panels with structured networking
- Corporate-hosted mixers (Walmart, International Paper, Belk, McLeod, Supply Chain Gals)
- Speed-networking nights with advisory board members
- Student panels featuring recent graduates
- Mock career fair booths staffed by alumni

**Activity ideas:**

- Invite-only alumni dinners (5-10 years out)

- Industry hot-topic roundtables
- LinkedIn headshot pop-ups
- Mixers at local restaurants or on-campus lounges

### 4.2 Personal and Professional Development

**Programming ideas:**

- Resume and LinkedIn workshops
- Salary negotiation seminars
- Semester kickoff goal-setting sessions
- Leadership conference debriefs
- Personal branding talks
- Internship panel with chapter upperclassmen
- Fireside chats with industry leaders

**Activity ideas:**

- Dress-for-Success fashion show
- Professional photo sessions
- Time management challenge week
- Productivity tool demonstrations
- Supply Chain Kahoot

### 4.3 Leadership Skills

**Programming ideas:**

- "Leading through Influence" workshops
- Cross-campus student leader panels
- Crisis management tabletop exercises
- Leadership case studies

**Activity ideas:**

- Member-led service projects
- Leadership book clubs
- Personal SWOT analysis with action planning
- Peer mentoring circles

### 4.4 Supply Chain Industry Knowledge

**Programming ideas:**

- "Day in the Life" speaker series (logistics, sourcing, planning)
- Technology trend briefings (automation, AI, blockchain)
- Distribution center or warehouse tours
- Case competition preparation sessions

**Activity ideas:**

- Inventory simulation games
- Virtual reality warehouse tours
- Interactive supply chain mapping exercises
- Data storytelling workshops
- Have members take the WISE Career Explorer quiz (section 7.4) and compare results

### 4.5 Ideas Borrowed from the Future Leaders Symposium

These sessions from the 2024 and 2025 symposium programs work well as a chapter meeting:

- **Dream Mapping:** members map out their career and personal goals, then share with a partner.
- **Building Your Web of Connections:** a short networking strategy workshop.
- **Vision and Values:** members write down their personal values and what they want from the year.
- **Plan, Source, Make, Deliver rotation:** small groups rotate through stations, one for each part of the supply chain.
- **Hot-topics table discussions:** each table has a discussion leader and one current industry topic.
- **Table chats with young professionals:** recent grads sit at topic tables and students rotate.
- **Themed panels:** "Life Outside the 9 to 5," "Unpacking the Myth of Perfection," and "The Interview Side: Acing It."
- **Reflection close:** end with a table discussion on key takeaways and one personal action item.

### 4.6 Event Planning Guide and Shared Slides

For step-by-step event planning, use the WISE Event Planning Resource Guide.

For inspiration, browse meeting slides from other WISE chapters in the WISE Resource National Bank (Google Drive). After each meeting, please add your own slides so other chapters can use them.

## 5. Making Everyone Feel Welcome

### 5.1 Best Practices (Setup & Logistics)

- Greet attendees at the entrance and dedicate the first five minutes to informal conversation.
- Provide name tents and optional pronoun stickers.
- Rotate seating or breakout groups so members meet new peers.
- Pair newcomers with "WISE buddies" for follow-up check-ins.
- Offer hybrid or recorded options for commuters and interns.

### 5.2 Ice-Breaker Activity Ideas

- 30-second partner introductions (speed rounds).
- Two Truths and a Lie, supply chain edition.

- "If you could ship any product anywhere, what and where?" quick round.
- Supply Chain Human Bingo focused on internship and travel experiences.

## 6. Leadership Structure

Examples from current chapters:

#### Executive Board (6-8 roles)

- President
- VP Programming
- VP Professional Development
- VP Membership
- VP Finance
- Communications Director
- Outreach/Sponsorship
- Events

#### Co-Presidents + Functional Directors

- Events, Marketing, and Philanthropy directors report to the co-presidents
- Decisions made together with the faculty advisor

#### Committee-Based / Flat

- Rotating facilitators run meetings
- Volunteer committees (Programming, Outreach, Finance) make decisions by consensus

## 7. National WISE Resources

### 7.1 WISE Future Leaders Symposium

The annual national WISE conference, held at the University of Arkansas in Fayetteville. It includes industry panels, workshops, networking, and the WISE Legends recognition, a hall-of-fame style award for women who shaped the supply chain field. Encourage four students from university to attend each fall.

Past programs: 2026 program, 2025 program, 2024 program. The programs are also a good source of speaker and company ideas for chapter events.

### 7.2 WISE Connections Advisory Board

A board of students from WISE universities that guides WISE's growth nationally. Members meet monthly, help plan the symposium and other events, and work with industry leaders. Applications open each year; watch the newsletter and @wiseconnections on Instagram.

**2026 Advisory Board:**

| Name | Role | University |
|---|---|---|
| Dr. Stephanie Thomas | Executive Director of WISE | University of Arkansas |
| Remington Reaves | Board Chair | University of Arkansas |
| Hannah Yong | Member | University of Arkansas |
| Nora Rolison | Member | Michigan State University |
| Samata Luintel | Member | Mississippi State University |
| Allie Gonzalez | Member | Western Michigan University |
| Erin Bath | Member | Colorado State University |
| Grace Hampton | Member | University of Oklahoma |
| Morgan Haight | Member | Brigham Young University |
| Libby Brewer | Member | North Carolina State University |
| Layla Goudy | Member | North Carolina A&T State University |
| Rupashi Gupta | Member | Indiana University |

Past board chairs: Katherine Thomas (2024) and Sophie Perrigin, Mississippi State (2025).

## 7.3 WISE Connections Newsletter Archive

WISE sends the WISE Connections email newsletter through Mailchimp, about every two months. It covers WISE events, chapter updates, industry insights, and career development opportunities. Share it with your members and send chapter news to WISE so it can be featured.

Subscribe | Full campaign archive

| Date | Issue | Summary |
|---|---|---|
| Oct 2026 | Symposium 2026 Special Edition | Highlights from the 2026 symposium |
| Aug 2026 | August 2026 Newsletter | Back to school after a busy summer |
| Jun 2026 | June 2026 Newsletter | Summer: challenge yourself |
| Apr 2026 | April 2026 Newsletter | Reset, refocus, and grow |
| Feb 2026 | February 2026 Newsletter | Chapter updates and development opportunities |
| Dec 2025 | December 2025 Newsletter | Year-end updates and highlights |
| Oct 2025 | Symposium 2025 Special Edition | Highlights from the 2025 symposium |
| Sep 2025 | September 2025 Newsletter | Fall updates and new chapter initiatives |
| Jun 2025 | June 2025 Newsletter | Summer highlights and conference info |
| Apr 2025 | April 2025 Newsletter | Spring updates and development resources |
| Feb 2025 | February 2025 Newsletter | Chapter activities and industry news |
| Jan 2025 | January 2025 Newsletter | New year updates and initiatives |

## 7.4 Website, Career Explorer, and Contact

- **Website (ongoing efforts from Chapter Resource Committee):** thewiseconnections.github.io
- **Questions:** WISE question form
- **Instagram:** @wiseconnections

- **LinkedIn:** WISE Connections National

## 8. Keeping This Guide Up to Date

- Send new chapters, officer changes, or social media updates through the question form so the chapter list and website stay current.
- Share your meeting cadence, chapter size, and structure so your chapter can be added to sections 3.3 to 3.5.
- Upload slides from your meetings to the WISE Resource National Bank.